

GUIDE

HOW TO USE OUR DIGICHECK?

Uncovering the potential for micro digital initiatives by assessing your company and digital maturity



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Our DigiCheck is designed to help companies in various sectors to benchmark their current digital level and to uncover potential for digital initiatives and digital projects. To guide you through the process, we developed this guide. The guide follows seven consecutive steps:

1. Define the scope of your digital check Plan the process
2. Start with the basics
3. Analyze the digital maturity
4. Prepare the presentation
5. Hold a workshop and discuss the results Start your digital initiatives and follow up

Each step suggests in this guide describes a specific approach and suggests practical tools, such as our online DigiCheck, checklists, and guiding questions. Like with all tools they need to be set in context and reflected against the unique situations of a company. This means that each step can be adapted, eliminated in case it was already done, or magnified and minified to dig deeper when needed. The ultimate goal is to support your digital journey and provide some new ways of achieving insights and concrete results. This guide will lead you through the process of analyzing your company, its digital readiness level, and its potential for impactful digital projects. The guide does not provide success or ideal pathway.

Every digital journey and company context is unique. This guide is there to show potential ways to unravel opportunities and seize the potential for an incremental, systematic, and actively designed transformation.



INTRODUCTION.

Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) are a driving force for job creation, business innovation, and sustainable growth in Cambodia. In Cambodia, SMEs account for a large share of business activities and form the backbone of the economy.

Digital transformation offers multiple opportunities for businesses across all sectors to improve their operations, processes, customer relationships, and core values. In many sectors, it can be seen that digital tools and new ways of doing business are redefining the status quo.

Nevertheless, for many companies, it is challenging to identify potential development areas and launchpads for digital initiatives. Shall I focus on my web presence? Shall I focus on my digital strategy? How can I be more productive and faster in creating value by rolling out software? These are just a few questions, leaders, executives and innovators are struggling with. Not knowing where to start can also paralyze digital innovation and the overall performance of an organization.

A digital maturity assessment can be an ideal starting point and combines systematic analysis with the development of solutions based on insights. It unveils by gathering data the organization's ability to create value through digital initiatives.

A digital maturity assessment is covering several sections, such as users, strategy, operation, process and organization, culture and leadership, data and customers, products and services, and technologies. The strategy, for instance, provides guidance, long-term views, and strategic direction. The processes are needed to achieve the strategic goals. Furthermore, the customer or user centricity helps align products and services and innovating the business activities by injecting better technologies, more market knowledge, and advanced user experiences. The user experience might be improved by using analytics to learn more about the wishes, pain points, and behavior of the customer and adjusting the cross channel experience.

The results can be a key predictor of success for companies launching a digital transformation and shaping their digital journey. In short, the assessment adds value to the company by providing intelligence and call for actions.



TIPS BEFORE YOU START



Ask Yourself Why

Knowing why you are doing the digital assessment is key to streamlining the process, the guiding questions, and the expected results. It also helps you to set focus on main pain points, such as logistics, operations, or sales. Decide between a holistic approach, looking at all, or a more targeted approach in case major problems and opportunities are already visible.



Don't Overanalyze

Overanalyzing can be tempting after exploring the potential for innovation from other sectors or digging deeper into your own business. In this context, analysis is not an end by itself and has the goal to launch digital initiatives and projects. By going systematically through the steps of the assessment, main development areas will pop up almost automatically. Simply put, go as deep as needed but not deeper. Aiming for perfect systems instead of experimenting can be paralyzing!



Collaborate

The assessment can be done by one person in a resource-saving way. But this person needs access to the brain power and knowledge of the company. In particular when it comes to choosing the main development areas. It is necessary to listen carefully to several heads of departments and key staff to understand their perspective, pain points, ideas, and needs. A senior executive might see things differently than a tech expert, a data person, an operation manager, or the end user. In particular, trusted outside perspectives from befriended companies, fans or experts can lead to ideas beyond corporate cultural limitations and legacy systems, which often blind innovation potential.



It Is The Beginning

A digital maturity assessment is the starting point of a journey. From there you can plan the next steps and revisit the tools and approaches over and over again to track progress and to define new digital initiatives and projects.

RATE AND WEIGHT

Look at it like a game with batches, ranking and points. Rating helps you to give yourself scores and to compare scores from the past with current or potential future scores.

A digital maturity assessment consists of questions, which can be closed and open. Closed assessment tools, such as our DigiCheck, usually provide you scores based on the weighting and scoring of the responses. This enables comparison.

If the questions are not applicable to your business or you have different priorities, you can develop your own scoring system. For instance, when your company uses advanced data analytics and collects data across departments, you can give a higher score than when data is not collected and analyzed at all. When you have several categories, e.g. data and strategy, and both have high scores, you can call these development areas optimized and integrated, the opposite would be incidental or low developed. Focusing on the lower developed and important development areas can then be a conclusion. Scoring should be consistent through the assessment tool. A popular result matrix is the digital leadership matrix from Capgemini. Based on the insights you got from the assessment you can put yourself in a box and aim for being in another box in 2 years.

Another digital maturity model uses a scale with set criteria. The criteria help you find your level after the analysis.



STARTING THE ASSESSMENT

Our approach focuses on companies and tries to be less academic but in return adaptable, applicable to more sectors, companies with an innovation focus and concrete results. In the next seven steps we lay out a prototypical process to get started.



STEP-01

Define The Scope And Purpose Of The Assessment

The goal of a digital maturity assessment depends on the company's needs and resources, but also on the interest of the people doing the digital maturity assessment. For instance, a researcher has different results and insight ambitions than a CEO or consulting group. In general, companies aim at having a visualized overview showing their digital level and high potential areas to drive digital innovation by strategic investments and packaging human, financial and knowledge resources.

Goals of digital maturity assessment from a company perspective

Goals:	Benchmarking the current status with competitors and sectors	Defining development areas for digital projects and initiatives
Description:	Comparing the companies digital adoption level with other companies or along different dates	Adapting digital maturity tools to own specific focus areas to unveil high potential areas
Approach:	Online tools provided by service providers with big data sets or internal assessments from different date	Adapt digital tools and combine them with a general company assessment, observations and workshops

After this step:

- The goal of your assessment is clear and specific, e.g. "We want to benchmark our current status."
- The leadership is committed to go through the process

STEP-02

Plan The Process And Set Up The Key Documents

The complexity of a digital maturity assessment depends on the preset goals. Knowing where you stand by comparison with other companies based on set indicators can be found through online tools in 10 to 20 mins. Our DigiCheck provides you with a first and fast glance at your digital maturity in comparison with other companies.

On the other hand, having a more holistic view on the overall company performance, existing digital assets and how digital tools increase productivity can take longer and needs a mix of methods.

In this step, you define the method and what to do first and at the very end. As we follow a holistic approach the next steps can be guiding for you. Nevertheless, you should already lock in the key parameters:



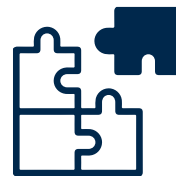
TIME

From when to when shall the assessment be implemented? First briefing to final results



OBJECTIVE

What do we want to achieve with the assessment?



RESOURCE

How many resources can we allocate for the assessment and potential initiatives? E.g. hiring technical staff, working with service providers



ACTION

What actions are needed for the assessment and using the results? How do we document the process?

After this step:

- The timeframe for the assessment is clear. E.g. 2 weeks
- The method is clear, e.g. reading strategy papers, doing an online assessment, adding interviews, reaching out to experts
- The responsible person is assigned and backed up by the leadership. For E.g. an announcement in the team meeting is made
- The potential investment sum is defined. E.g. when the results are good, we invest 10.000USD

STEP-03

Start With The Basic Questions And Market Research

This step is about developing an in-depth understanding of the sector of the company and its general business model.

The analysis can be started from a sector angle. For instance, SME farming mango can begin by exploring the agriculture sector in its country, countries with similar conditions and different regions to learn more about sector trends, technology use cases, and consumer behavior. To what kind of products can mangos be processed? What are the products with the highest yield?

The company could find out that mango farmers in Vietnam are using computer vision to validate the health of its mango trees and digital marketing strategies to skip intermediaries through digital platforms or that mango jams promise higher revenues.

Exploring other sectors with an innovation-oriented mindset can help you identify technology trends and use cases. It also helps you collect basic market data, such as the size of the market, market share of your own company, number of competitors, new market entrants, and customer segments. The data is often provided by business chambers, consulting groups, statistical offices, and other stakeholders in the form of reports, sector briefings and other publications.

After unraveling the market secrets, the analysis continues with the company information about the size, skills of staff, distribution of staff, the structure of the business, organization, financial numbers, products and services, and culture. This step also involves a broader look at it by including the social media appearance, the web presence, talking with customers, colleagues, and other sources. Below are listed guiding questions which can help you get started:

- **How does the business make money? Who decides what? What is the product or service?**
- **Name? Where is the company? Who works at the company? Skills? How many employees?**
- **Who operates what? Daily work?**
- **What technologies does the company use?**
- **With whom does the company work?**
- **Who are our competitors? What are they doing better or worse?**

After having refreshed the basic information about the company, it is worth having a closer look at the products or services and the way they are produced. The information is more difficult to get and should not be based on gut feelings.

The reliability of the information depends on its accuracy, actuality, and consistency. Potential sources are short customer interviews, analyzing the products of competitors, reading reviews, or talking to experts. If this information is not available or time is short, you can still go ahead with our guiding questions:

- What is the product? What makes it unique?
- How do we attract customers? What makes them curious about the product? How sensitive are customer segments to pricing?
- How aware, interested are our customers?
- How is the customer journey designed? What are the pain points and best touchpoints?
- What are functional, technical, environmental, social and socio-economic factors around our products?
- Who buys the product? Who not and why?
- What is good about the product? Where is it sold? How is it delivered?
- How is it produced? How are market leaders producing it?
- How are competitors producing and selling it?
- How is the branding and packaging?

In the last step of the overall analysis, we list some questions, which help you contrast your own company from others:

- How big is the market?
- Who are competitors? What are they doing better or worse?
- We are different because ...
- Our ... is better because ...
- We are weaker at ...
- Market leaders are doing ... or are not doing ...
- How concentrated is the industry with how many competitors?
- Who is supplying whom and what is the bargaining power of the suppliers? Can our product be substituted, combined, minimized, maximized?

TIPS:

While you are going through the questions and spending some time pondering the company, one tip is to make notes about open questions, blind spots, aspects, which you see skeptical or where you see potential for growth. These notes will help you later develop solutions. Using formulations like if ... then ... or the more we ... the better ... can help you formulate first ideas.

STEP-04

Analyze The Digital Maturity

At the core of the assessment is the digital maturity assessment. Our DigiCheck tool, which provides in 10mins to 15mins time an overview of the use of software and digital tools, modern collaboration and culture, data and customers, and digital strategy and investment can be found here. Alternatively, there are other assessment tools on the market for specific sectors and with specific angles. The tool can be accessed here:



As a reward for answering the questions, you will see your performance in these four use new DigiCheck categories by comparison to other companies in the sector. DigiCheck will also rate and weigh the responses to give you an overall score.

It is important to not blindly trust the tool and add your own information from the previous analysis. Diverse data sources and methods are key to producing good results. Using the tool can always be combined with guided workshops, observations, interviews, desk review and so on.

After this step:

- The digital assessment was implemented online or based on a printed questionnaire.
- The scores are clear and show first directions for digital projects.
- The scores also highlight developed and less developed areas.
- The scores benchmark your company and need to be reflected and openly discussed

STEP-05

Prepare The Presentation

Preparing the final presentation enables you to show the most important results and potential key development areas. One key development area could be using data or improving the digital customer journey by adding or improving existing channels. It is the starting point for ideation and solution development.

To visualize the complex amount of information, we designed a template, which is structured in a future vision and three development areas. After the assessment, a future vision can be formulated. We recommend choosing up to three development areas.

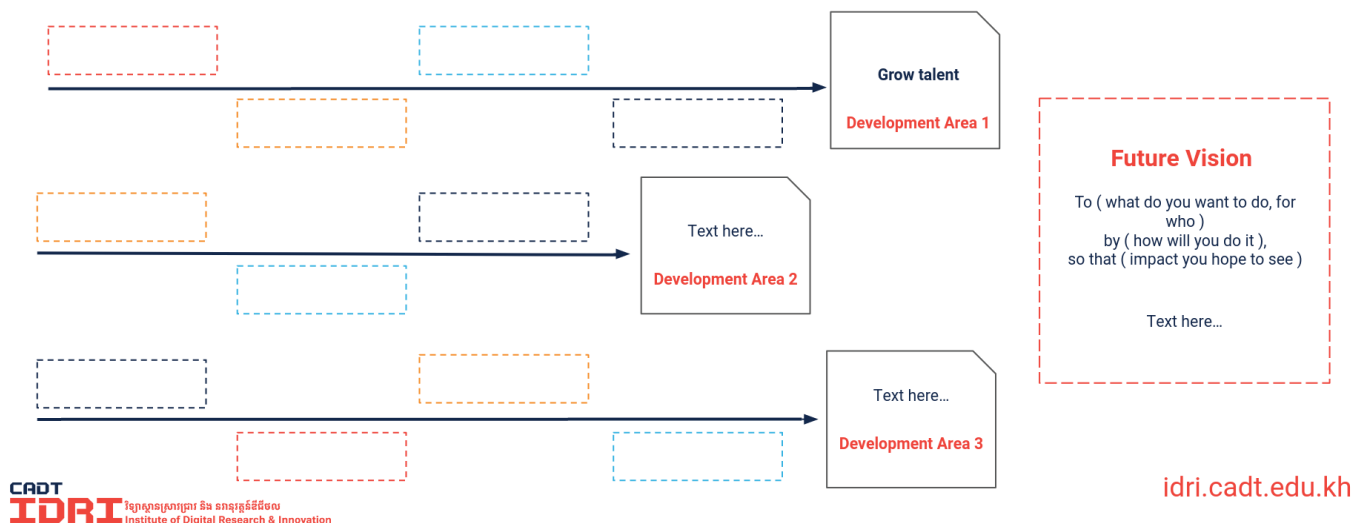
Future Vision: For our customers, we build a seamless multichannel top-notch digital experience.

Dev1: Web presence > SEO, digital content, pop up dev., online payment

Dev2: Data > learn basics about analytics, send staff to training, by software, analyze data regularly

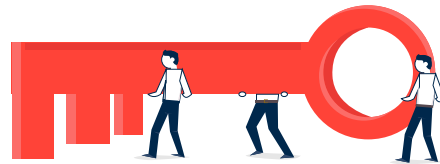
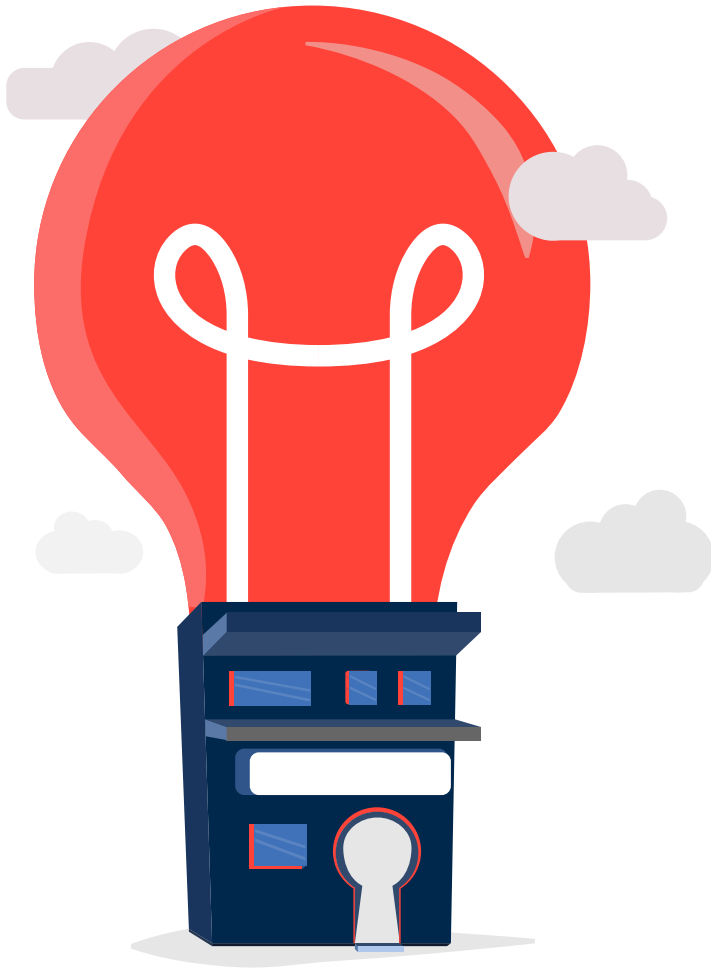
Dev3: Digital culture > shorter meetings, 10% time for relevant training, experimenting with new methods

The template can be integrated into a slide deck after showing the most relevant findings matching the development areas.



After this step:

- Development areas with high potential and viability are defined
- The results are summarized pointing out the most significant findings
- Notes and findings from the previous steps are added to complete the picture
- The results can be visualized using PowerPoint or other presentation tools.



IMPORTANT:

Focus of the presentation on the most promising development areas. You can use criteria for that.

Criteria can be:

- Economic viability: How much would it cost? What would be a return on investment?
- User-centricity: Would it improve customer satisfaction? Can we generate or convert customers?
- Sales: Does it lead to more sales?
- Ease of work: Does it increase productivity and workflows?
- Connection to existing projects and priorities: Can we link it to our running projects? idea.

STEP-06

Present And Ideate In A Work Shop

The sixth step is designed to get feedback and to explore development areas with key staff and experts. In the step before the stage was set by summarizing, analyzing and visualizing the results.



For this workshop, an open and friendly atmosphere should be created, which invites everyone to take part and to feel free to share ideas, feedback, and add views. The findings are incubated and deepened in this step as well as the development areas by combining the analysis with the brain power of the company, and its staff. Ideas can be reshuffled, insights questioned and a critical dialogue led.

After this step:

- Development areas with high potential and viability are discussed and potentially replaced with more promising ones.
- The results are reflected and understood.
- A roadmap for the next development areas and activities is defined and accepted by the key people.

STEP-07

Follow Up

What is next after all this work? At the beginning of change management, most people are excited and motivated. A few days later routines strike back and the euphoria is gone. Planning the next steps and keeping the transformation up is a leadership task. The insights and development areas can be revisited after some days and one more time reflecting. Then, the top three activities can be selected and delegated to the people in charge of implementation. The vision, development areas, and respective activities can be transferred into management software or Excel for monitoring the results.

Conclusion

Digital maturity assessment tools are a good launchpad for embarking on digital journeys and exploring new opportunities. They are in particular powerful when combined with trend analysis, competitor analysis, and other methods and tools.

In the end, a first assessment can be done without losing much time and resources and bear the first fruits when discussed in a collaborative workshop format. Digital transformation encompasses digital culture and having an insight-based discussion on the current digital level and potential initiatives benefits the company and the skill development of its staff. Here is a checklist for the first steps:



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DIGITAL MATURITY ASSESSMENT CHECKLIST

Step 1: Define the scope and purpose of the assessment ▪ Set goals based on what you need ▪ Define potential investment scopes	Not Started Not Started
Step 2: Plan the process and set up the key documents ▪ Define the timeline, expected outcome, e.g. a short slide deck ▪ Set up the team ▪ Create the key documents for documentation, like a word file	Not Started Not Started Not Started
Step 3: Start with the basic questions and market	
Step 4: Analyze the digital maturityresearch ▪ Observe and make notes in the company ▪ Talk to colleagues and learn more about their digital skills and environment ▪ Use the questionnaire ▪ Use an online tool	Not Started Not Started Not Started Not Started
Step 5: Prepare the presentation ▪ Create the layout, structure and content ▪ Keep it short and to the point ▪ Visualize the results ▪ Visualize the potential and opportunities	Not Started Not Started Not Started Not Started
Step 6: Present and ideate in a workshop ▪ Get feedback on findings ▪ Get ideas for projects ▪ Summarize and close the assessment	Not Started Not Started Not Started
Step 7: Follow up ▪ Analysis and ideation is the first step ▪ Manifesting the ideas in activities follows ▪ Monitor and track the process	Not Started Not Started Not Started

After all, the steps, monitor the results and start the full cycle again to see your digital transformation!